

A nikah is too important to leave to memory and momentum. Work through every stage together as a family — tick each box with honesty — so nothing that matters gets missed in the excitement.

Stage 1 — Before the search

- ☐ Write down what your family is looking for: marja followed, practice expectations, education & career direction, location flexibility, timeline.
- ☐ Decide who is involved and how: who acts as wali/guardian, how families will communicate, what privacy to expect.
- ☐ Agree as a family on non-negotiables vs. preferences — before any profile is browsed.

Stage 2 — Vetting a prospect

- ☐ Check consistency: does their description of daily practice match how they actually live?
- ☐ Is their family involved early and openly? Note direct vs. evasive answers.
- ☐ Verify the practical: identity, education/employment claims, marital history.
- ☐ Through trusted mutual contacts, ask about character and reputation.

Stage 3 — The families meet

- ☐ Exchange family backgrounds honestly — no surprises later.
- ☐ Discuss living arrangements, finances, and religious practice in the household.
- ☐ Let both sides ask anything — the awkward questions now prevent regret later.
- ☐ If at a distance: use video, keep the wali in the loop at every step.

Stage 4 — The nikah contract

- ☐ Agree the mahr clearly — amount, form, and timing — before the ceremony.
- ☐ Put any additional lawful conditions in writing as part of the contract.
- ☐ Confirm particulars (witnesses, recitation, the wali's role) with your marja/scholar — rulings vary.
- ☐ Arrange the nikah nama documentation your locality requires; keep copies with both families.

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Stage 5 — After the nikah

- ☐ Plan the transition: housing, finances, and the household's religious life together.
- ☐ Keep communication open between families in the early months.
- ☐ Remember: most new-marriage friction is logistical, not fundamental — early support prevents hardening.

Note: This is a practical family organizer, not a fiqh manual. Confirm all religious particulars with the marja your family follows.

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